



ATTRACTING TOP RECRUITERS, ST. XAVIER'S, KOLKATA, STRESSES OVERALL DEVELOPMENT

riculum is very different. We also stress extra-curricular activities as well as co-curricular work." Every paper at Xavier's is evaluated 20 per cent internally and 80 per cent externally. This 20 per cent has various components like internal exams, seminar, assignments and internship and every student has to fulfil these components. Moreover, it has companies like Vodafone, IBM, TCS, HSBC, Wipro and PricewaterhouseCoopers recruiting students from campus. Even the National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC) recognised the college as an 'A' grade institution in 2003. In May 2006, it was declared a Centre with Potential for Excellence by the University

INSIGHT

Rev J. Felix Raj SJ

Principal, St. Xavier's College, Kolkata

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Grants Commission (UGC).

It now aims to provide more professional experience to the students at the UG level, what Raj SJ calls "a more exposure-oriented course". In 2005, they initiated an academia-industry interface where industrialists are brought in to the college and students are exposed to what new techniques in the industrial world. Students also go for a three-week internship at one of the companies and have to submit a detailed report as project work.

SRCC, which has been displaced to second place this year, has not lost its edge. The calibre of the faculty is excellent, and SRCCians hardly have to worry about getting a job as they have an impressive cadre of recruiters like Ernst & Young, Barclays and Deutsche Bank. Moreover, the college is sprucing its infrastructure to match global standards. Last year, it spent about Rs 10 crore to upgrade its library, which is now air-conditioned and enabled with radio frequency identification technology, a new audio-visual room with teleconferencing facilities (contributed by the alumni), renovate its hostels with new furniture, flooring and electrical wiring, better toilets, kitchen and dining area. Also, thanks to the upcoming Commonwealth Games, the college is getting a new hostel block for girls (with 50 rooms) and a 2,500-seater sports stadium for indoor events like women's wrestling, basketball and table tennis with a spa and cafeteria. Few, if any, public colleges have such facilities.

P.C. Jain, principal, SRCC, now wants to focus on making the college a "centre for teaching and research of global standards". It has been conducting training workshops for faculty members, some of who are now going to present papers in economics and business at conferences abroad. "We want to be ranked in a global context," he says. He also wants to encourage "equality and diversity" in the college, part of which includes grooming students (who come in through the various quotas), both academi-

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1. In terms of number of Students on a single campus